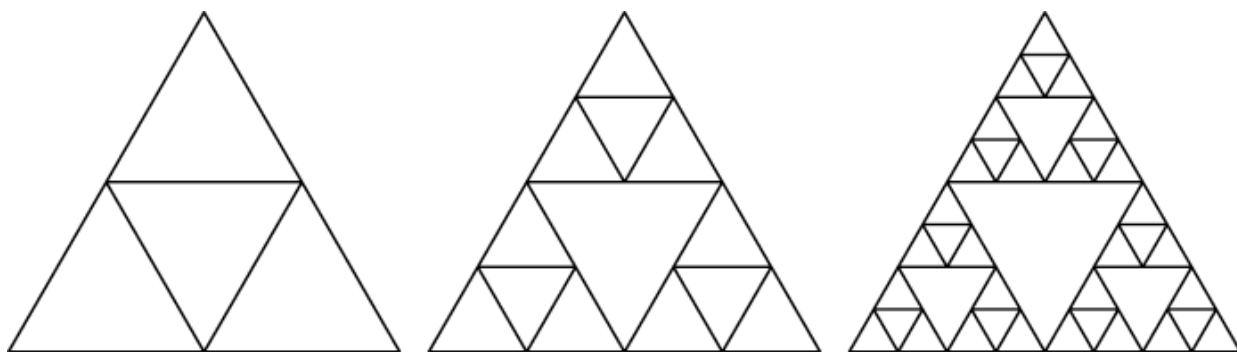




*Figure 1-4: Sierpiński triangles are fractals (recursive shapes) that include Sierpiński triangles.*

In a programming context, a *recursive function* is a function that calls itself. Before we explore recursive functions, let's take a step back and understand how regular functions work. Programmers tend to take function calls for granted, but even experienced programmers will find it worthwhile to review functions in the next section.